

1814, ENGLAND

Stephenson's locomotive

George Stephenson, an English engineer also known as the "Father of the Railways," built his first locomotive in 1814 to haul wagons at a coal mine in northeast England. He called it *Blücher* after the dynamic Prussian general who would later fight alongside the British at the Battle of Waterloo in 1815. *Blücher* had a top speed of 4 mph (6.4 km/h) and could haul eight loaded coal wagons weighing 33 tons (30 metric tons) up an incline. In 1825, Stephenson oversaw construction of the world's first public railroad between the towns of Stockton and Darlington in the north of England. Four years later, Stephenson built his most famous locomotive, the *Rocket*, which reached a record speed of 36 mph (58 km/h).

